

MADROSARAI

COMMON MADROSARAI HUMANOID

Madrosarai are magically blooded humanoids native to **Zakaron**. Their semitranslucent skin takes its color from the arcane blood moving beneath it, producing metallic gold, vivid lime, crimson, stone-gray, teal, umber, and other less common hues. Each bloodline carries a distinct magical resonance that can influence physical endurance, emotional regulation, psychic aptitude, or affinity with particular technologies.

Bloodline manifests independently of ordinary parentage. A child can develop a color absent from either parent and from every known member of their immediate family. Zakaron's blood-clans consequently grew into institutions larger than biological lineages. They identify emerging bloodlines, train their associated abilities, preserve arcane techniques, arrange professional placements, and claim obligations from the people whose gifts they cultivate.

Before the **Star Dream**, these clans competed through espionage, surgical alteration, industrial sabotage, assassination, alliance, and open war. Their conflicts contributed to the **Rupture Wars** that stripped Zakaron's atmosphere and forced its survivors to rebuild along the inner surface of the planet. Reconstruction made cooperation with the **Vesk** holds necessary for survival, while preserving the blood-clans that had helped cause the catastrophe.

Madrosarai blood responds visibly and magically to emotional stress. Strong emotion can brighten the skin, change the rhythm of arcane circulation, disrupt blood-keyed equipment, and expose intentions during negotiation or covert work. Madrosarai children therefore receive extensive training in breath control, pulse regulation, facial stillness, deliberate speech, and the management of magical responses. Their calm exterior coexists with intense feeling and constant physical effort.

During the War of the Open Stars, Madrosarai operatives sabotaged relays, penetrated command networks, seized navigation records, assassinated officials, and prepared worlds for Vesk assault forces. The **Still-Drive Accords** ended Zakaron's expansion while leaving its blood-clans, intelligence services, and military industries intact.

Now in Lapse 29, Madrosarai live throughout the **Settled Systems**. Some remain bound to Zakaron blood-clans through family, education, debt, employment, or inherited oath. Others have little connection to the planet beyond ancestry. **Erbium Industries LLC** heavily recruits Madrosarai as intelligence analysts, cyberneticists,



surgeons, negotiators, security specialists, and restricted-access personnel while pursuing commercial substitutes for the blood-reactive technologies their clans control.

If you want to roleplay a disciplined character whose inheritance grants real magical power while family, clan, government, and corporation all claim an interest in how that power is used, you should play a madrosarai.

YOU MIGHT...

- ◆ Monitor your breathing, pulse, posture, and skin brightness whenever you enter a stressful conversation.
- ◆ Feel pride in the skills your blood-clan taught you while resenting the obligations attached to that education.
- ◆ Preserve information carefully because knowledge can protect your family, destroy a rival, or destabilize an entire institution.
- ◆ Pursue a profession associated with another bloodline to prove that aptitude does not determine purpose.
- ◆ Treat emotional composure as a practical discipline while seeking private spaces where you can express yourself freely.

OTHERS PROBABLY...

- ◆ Assume your calm manner means you feel little or remain unaffected by cruelty, grief, or fear.
- ◆ Expect you to possess assassination training, covert contacts, or access to classified Zakaron technology.
- ◆ Judge your occupation, temperament, and social status according to the color of your blood.
- ◆ Watch your skin for changes and treat ordinary biological reactions as evidence of dishonesty.
- ◆ Believe your clan affiliation reveals your loyalties more accurately than your stated choices.

PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION

Madrosarai are slender humanoids who usually stand between 5 and 6 feet tall. Their proportions resemble those of humans, though they commonly possess long limbs, narrow shoulders, elongated ears, and relatively light builds. Adult weight varies considerably but averages around 140 pounds. Their natural lifespan is similar to that of a human.

Their most immediately visible feature is their semitranslucent skin. Madrosarai tissues scatter light while allowing the color of their blood to show through, giving the entire body a luminous or saturated appearance. Veins, capillary structures, and areas of high circulation remain faintly visible beneath the surface, particularly around the face, throat, hands, and inner arms.

A Madrosarai infant initially appears pale and milky. Between approximately 3 and 5 years of age, the child's bloodline settles. Color moves rapidly through the body over several days as the blood acquires its stable magical resonance. The resulting hue can differ sharply from those of either parent.

Bloodline color remains stable through ordinary life. Injury, illness, cybernetic alteration, magical effects, and intense emotional states can temporarily change brightness, translucence, or saturation. A frightened teal-blooded Madrosarai might develop bright branching veins along the neck. A furious red-blooded Madrosarai may glow visibly around the eyes and hands. A gold-blooded speaker addressing a crowd can appear to carry a faint metallic sheen beneath their skin.

Madrosarai possess a second set of eyes on the back of the skull. These rear eyes provide awareness of movement and activity behind them, though they share the same visual limitations as the forward pair. Each set can blink, close, and focus independently. Madrosarai architecture, helmets, hairstyles, headrests, and medical equipment accommodate this expanded field of view.

Their ears extend into long tapered structures that frequently sag or hang along the sides of the head. Ear shape varies by family and region. Some Madrosarai decorate them with rings, embedded arcane conductors, clan seals, sensory augmentations, or chains linking the ear to the jaw or collar.

Each Madrosarai hand possesses two opposable thumbs. The secondary thumb grows from the opposite side of the palm, allowing secure manipulation from either direction. This anatomy supports exceptional manual control during surgery, weapon handling, delicate fabrication, cybernetic installation, and simultaneous use of several compact tools.

Madrosarai blood is biologically necessary and magically active. It transports oxygen and nutrients while carrying a measurable arcane charge through the body. Blood loss therefore weakens both ordinary physiology and bloodline abilities. Medical treatment often requires equipment calibrated to the patient's specific resonance.

Many Madrosarai use cybernetics designed to connect directly with their circulation. Blood-reactive interfaces can verify identity, regulate augmentations, change operating modes in response to physiological state, or permit control through minor alterations in pulse and arcane pressure. Zakaron-made implants often leave visible channels of metal or ceramic beneath the skin, illuminated by the blood flowing around them.

SOCIETY

Madrosarai society developed through the blood-clans of Zakaron. A blood-clan combines elements of an extended family, school, professional association, intelligence network, archive, political constituency, and mutual-defense organization. Some clans control entire districts or industrial systems. Others consist of several dispersed households preserving one specialized technique.

A blood-clan rarely consists of one bloodline color. Most cultivate several related aptitudes and maintain arrangements with other clans when a child manifests an uncommon resonance. A lime-blooded child born into a clan known for red-blooded combat specialists might remain with their birth family while receiving technical education from an allied clan. A rare umber-blooded child might attract competing sponsorship offers before reaching adolescence.

These arrangements provide education, medical care, professional contacts, cybernetic access, legal representation, and protection. They also create divided authority over a child's future. Parents, instructors, clan officers, and government registrars may each claim responsibility for ensuring that a valuable bloodline receives appropriate training.

The recognized blood-clans are represented through the **Conclave of Veils**, one of the two chambers governing the **Zakaron Concord**. The term **veil** refers to the body of knowledge, obligations, protected identities, blood samples, techniques, and classified relationships maintained by a clan. A clan's public face forms its outer veil. Its internal records and restricted practices form deeper veils accessible according to rank and function.

The Conclave oversees intelligence law, covert diplomacy, cybernetic regulation, classified research, blood-reactive technology, and internal security. Its figurehead, the **Saivara** or First Veil, shares the Paired Mandate with the Vesk Kharduun.

Daily life throughout **Kharosai** is highly integrated. Madrosarai and Vesk live in the same neighborhoods, operate mixed military units, work in the same factories, attend shared schools, and belong to political coalitions crossing ancestral lines. Blood-clans and Vesk holds often maintain formal compacts covering territory, defense, industrial production, marriage, medical support, and mutual retaliation.

The two systems reward different forms of public conduct. Vesk institutions value visible responsibility, physical endurance, and direct commitment. Madrosarai clans place greater weight on controlled presentation, information management, technical precision, and the ability to act without revealing the full scope of one's purpose. These values complement one another during crisis and create deep suspicion during political disputes.

Emotional discipline begins in childhood. Madrosarai learn to regulate breathing, pulse, circulation, eye movement, hand tension, and the brightness of their skin. Training exercises include maintaining a steady appearance during argument, separating fear from physical reaction, controlling the blood response produced by pain, and communicating strong emotion without allowing it to disrupt equipment or spellwork.

Madrosarai culture also provides structured forms of emotional release. Families maintain private rooms with adjustable lighting where changes in skin color can be expressed without observation. Some clans use controlled sparring, blood-light dance, musical performance, supervised confrontation, or ritual recitation to help members process emotions they suppress during public duties. Access to such practices frequently depends on rank, wealth, and available privacy.

A person who displays intense emotion in public may face social and professional consequences. Clan authorities often treat visible distress as evidence that a member requires correction, reassignment, or temporary exclusion from sensitive work. Employers throughout the Settled Systems have adopted similar standards while ignoring the training and effort required to satisfy them.

Bloodline expectations influence occupation. Gold-blooded Madrosarai are frequently directed toward command and negotiation. Lime bloodlines dominate engineering, surgery, fabrication, and cybernetics. Red bloodlines are recruited into combat and enforcement. Stone bloodlines are associated with medicine, analysis, and philosophy. Teal bloodlines carry expectations of service and endurance. Umber bloodlines are drawn into psychic research, occult work, and intelligence.

These associations reflect real aptitudes reinforced by centuries of specialized training. They also restrict personal choice. A lime-blooded artist may be told that technical work would make better use of their inheritance. A red-blooded medic may spend their career proving that controlled aggression carries little relevance to their chosen practice.

Madrosarai who reject blood-clan authority are often called **Unveiled**. The word originally described a person who had lost clan protection and whose secrets could therefore be exposed without retaliation. Modern reformers use it as a voluntary identity representing political independence from inherited obligation.

Some Unveiled Madrosarai establish cooperative schools, independent clinics, and offworld professional networks. Others lose access to clan archives, specialized medicine, blood-keyed equipment, housing, and relatives who remain subject to clan authority. Erbium frequently recruits Unveiled specialists by offering resources once supplied by their clans, then replaces inherited obligation with corporate dependence.



BELIEFS

Madrosarai beliefs vary between blood-clans, districts, and diaspora communities, but several ideas recur throughout their traditions.

A **veil** marks the boundary between what belongs to the self and what has been entrusted to others. Madrosarai ethics place considerable importance on choosing what to disclose, identifying who possesses authority to receive it, and protecting information given in confidence. Privacy, secrecy, discretion, and deception remain distinct practices judged according to purpose and consequence.

Emotional control is treated as a form of bodily competence. A skilled Madrosarai understands their feelings, recognizes the physical changes those feelings produce, and decides how those changes will influence their actions. Many traditions also emphasize the need for safe release. Permanent suppression can damage health, distort judgment, and leave a person vulnerable to sudden loss of control.

Bloodline grants capability and social expectation. Traditional clan teachings describe magical aptitude as an inheritance held in trust for future generations. A person benefits from techniques preserved by their clan and therefore owes service in return. Reform movements place primary authority with the individual whose body carries the blood.

Blood samples occupy an important place in clan observance. Many clans preserve small sealed samples from respected ancestors, teachers, inventors, and fallen operatives. These samples may serve as memorials, magical references, biometric keys, or sources used to verify the authenticity of inherited techniques. The practice creates recurring disputes over consent, posthumous authority, and ownership.

The rear eyes carry practical and ceremonial significance. Important clan promises are traditionally witnessed by people positioned both before and behind the speaker. This custom represents accountability for immediate intention and for consequences that emerge after the commitment has been made.

The survival of Kharosai shapes Madrosarai ideas of public obligation. Atmosphere, gravity, containment, and power depend on coordinated maintenance. Sabotage against these systems is treated as an attack upon the entire population. Political factions disagree sharply over which institutions may invoke planetary survival to justify secrecy, coercion, and emergency authority.

Many Madrosarai interpret the Star Dream through the history of Zakaron. Traditionalists believe the revelation offered their world a larger arena in which its disciplined society could create order. Others regard the War of the Open Stars as proof that inherited power and institutional confidence can turn revelation into conquest.

Popular Edicts master the physical expression of your emotions, protect information entrusted to you, use inherited abilities deliberately, honor obligations you knowingly accepted, preserve techniques that keep others alive, consider the later consequences of a present decision

Popular Anathema expose a protected confidence for personal status, claim ownership over another person's blood or body, force someone into a profession solely because of their bloodline, endanger shared infrastructure through private rivalry, use emotional discipline to conceal abuse from those placed at risk

SAMPLE NAMES

Common Madrosarai names include Andrest, Aveline, Bakile, Cerast, Ilyren, Kesara, Lucerne, Nevel, Odelria, Palerne, Saivel, Sankille, Tarev, Velesh, and Yssara.

A Madrosarai may use a personal name, a family name, and a blood-clan affiliation. Clan affiliation can be stated formally, withheld in ordinary conversation, or replaced with an occupational veil.

Formal examples include **Cerast of the Veyra Veil**, **Odelria Saren of the Ninth Glass**, and **Nevel, Unveiled of Black Meridian**.

Zakaron-born Madrosarai may possess different names for family, clan service, and classified work. Diaspora Madrosarai frequently shorten these conventions or adopt naming practices from their home communities.

OTHER INFORMATION

THE SIX MAJOR BLOODLINES

Madrosarai recognize many minor shades and mixed resonances, though six bloodlines possess the largest populations and most established institutions.

GOLD BLOOD

Gold blood produces a metallic sheen visible beneath the skin and a resonance associated with authority, coordination, and social pressure. Gold-blooded Madrosarai are heavily represented in command, diplomacy, political administration, and clan leadership.

Their education often emphasizes speech, posture, threat assessment, and the management of group behavior. A gold-blooded child may receive leadership training long before expressing any personal interest in authority.

LIME BLOOD

Lime blood appears bright green or yellow-green and reacts strongly to crafted systems, surgery, and arcane machinery. Lime-blooded Madrosarai dominate Zakaron's cybernetic laboratories, surgical theaters, precision factories, and implant-maintenance professions.

Clans frequently treat lime blood as an industrial asset. Apprenticeship contracts can begin in childhood, and rare technical aptitudes may become subjects of competition between manufacturers and blood-clans.

RED BLOOD

Red blood carries a strong relationship with aggression, pain response, and sudden physical exertion. Red-blooded Madrosarai learn to release emotional pressure in controlled bursts, making them valued as soldiers, duelists, emergency responders, and enforcement personnel.

Their anger is simultaneously cultivated and restricted. Institutions expect them to access aggression immediately during approved violence and contain it completely when confronting the people who direct them.

STONE BLOOD

Stone blood appears gray, beige, silver, or muted brown. Its resonance supports analysis, bodily assessment, and the precise observation of weaknesses. Stone-blooded Madrosarai are common among physicians, combat diagnosticians, strategists, investigators, and philosophers.

Their apparent calm often attracts expectations of permanent neutrality. A stone-blooded person who takes a passionate political position may be accused of abandoning the objectivity their blood was supposed to provide.

TEAL BLOOD

Teal blood ranges from blue-green to deep cyan and supports endurance, pain tolerance, and resistance to physical collapse. Teal-blooded Madrosarai are heavily recruited into hazardous maintenance, military support, emergency medicine, exterior work, and long-duration assignments.

Service traditions frequently celebrate their reliability while assigning them a disproportionate share of work expected to cause injury.

UMBER BLOOD

Umbre blood appears dark brown, violet, black-purple, or nearly opaque beneath the skin. It carries an affinity for psychic phenomena, occult spellwork, hidden memory, and effects that resist ordinary arcane classification.

Umbre-blooded Madrosarai are associated with intelligence analysis, counterintelligence, psychic research, anomaly containment, and restricted clan archives. Their abilities attract both reverence and intrusive monitoring.

VEILWORK

Veilwork is the broad Madrosarai term for disciplines involving controlled information, covert access, protected identity, and action performed without public attribution.

Veilwork can include surveillance, counterintelligence, encryption, social infiltration, assassination, sabotage, witness protection, covert medicine, extraction of endangered personnel, and the movement of information through hostile territory.

Most Madrosarai receive only basic instruction in detecting surveillance, protecting clan information, and identifying manipulation. Professional veil agents undergo extensive training in disguise, emotional containment, rear-field awareness, blood control, cybernetic intrusion, weapons, and the use of several simultaneous cover identities.

Settled Systems media frequently treats every Madrosarai as a potential assassin. Most Madrosarai work in ordinary occupations and possess no greater combat training than their neighbors. Their cultural familiarity with information security still makes unfamiliar people cautious around them.

Erbium Industries employs Madrosarai veil specialists in Internal Continuity, executive protection, industrial counterespionage, debt enforcement, relay security, and investigations involving proprietary technology. Corporate contracts frequently require disclosure of clan training while withholding information about the operation the employee has been assigned to support.

BLOOD-REACTIVE TECHNOLOGY

Zakaron's most distinctive technologies combine arcane circulation with cybernetic engineering. A **blood-keyed interface** reads the user's biological identity, magical resonance, pulse, emotional condition, and deliberate changes in blood pressure.

Simple blood keys function as secure authentication. More advanced systems allow a Madrosarai to operate machinery through controlled physiological signals, alter implant behavior by shifting emotional state, or channel innate magic through a cybernetic device.

Military applications include weapon safeties that respond to bloodline resonance, armor that adjusts around injury, targeting systems linked to pulse control, and encrypted neural networks accessible only through a registered arcane profile.

Blood-reactive systems create serious medical and political risks. A clan or manufacturer controlling an implant's calibration profile can restrict who repairs it, disable advanced functions, or detect unauthorized biological changes. Some domestic military augmentations contain remote safeties justified as protection against capture.

Erbium has spent centuries attempting to reproduce blood-reactive technology using cultivated samples, synthetic arcane fluids, and non-Madrosarai test subjects. Commercial systems can imitate basic authentication and physiological control. Zakaron retains a significant lead in systems requiring the full interaction of living blood, magic, and neural intent.

Offworld Madrosarai employment agreements often authorize medical sampling and retention of arcane-profile data. Erbium describes these records as necessary for safe equipment compatibility. Blood-clans describe the same programs as a long-term effort to separate Zakaron technology from the people who created it.

PLACE IN THE SETTLED SYSTEMS

Madrosarai are widely employed in cybernetics, surgery, intelligence, diplomacy, weapons research, secure communications, investigation, corporate security, arcane engineering, and combat medicine.

Their reputation for composure can improve access to sensitive work. It also encourages employers to place them in situations involving secrecy, distress, violence, or morally compromising decisions while assuming they will remain functional without support.

Settled Systems institutions frequently classify Madrosarai bloodline information as medical data, occupational aptitude, security information, or equipment-compatibility information according to whichever category grants the institution the broadest access. A bloodline that creates no relevant workplace ability may still appear in personnel records.

Madrosarai born away from Zakaron display a wide range of relationships with blood-clan culture. Some families preserve formal clan affiliation for generations. Others maintain only recipes, emotional exercises, naming practices, or bloodline celebrations. Many have never entered Kharosai and possess no personal loyalty to the Concord.

Zakaron blood-clans continue to claim cultural responsibility for parts of the diaspora, particularly individuals carrying rare bloodlines or inherited access to restricted techniques. Diaspora reformers argue that ancestry and magical inheritance create no automatic political obligation.

Madrosarai serving in the Frontier Extraction Division commonly work as medics, implant technicians, operatives, security analysts, precision engineers, survey specialists, negotiators, and weapons personnel. Some enter service to acquire equipment or education unavailable outside a clan. Others use frontier assignments to place several systems between themselves and every institution claiming authority over their blood.

MADROSARAI MECHANICS

HIT POINTS

8

SIZE

Medium

SPEED

25 feet

ATTRIBUTE BOOSTS

Dexterity, Charisma, Free

ATTRIBUTE FLAW

Strength

LANGUAGES

Common

Madrosarai

Additional languages equal to your Intelligence modifier, if it is positive. Choose from the list of common languages and any other languages to which you have access, such as languages prevalent on your home world.

CONTAINED EMOTIONS

You keep your emotions contained. Creatures take a –2 circumstance penalty to **Sense Motive** checks against you. You gain a +1 circumstance bonus to saving throws against **emotion** effects. If you roll a success on a saving throw against an emotion effect, you get a critical success instead.

Heritages

GOLD-BLOODED MADROSARAI

Aurum blood fills your veins, giving your skin a metallic sheen that seems to glow under light. Your bloodline is often associated with leadership and the ability to coordinate others. You become trained in **Intimidation**. If you would automatically become trained in Intimidation (from your background or class, for example), you instead become trained in another skill of your choice. You gain the **Group Coercion** skill feat. If you roll a critical failure on an Intimidation check to **Coerce** a **humanoid**, you get a failure instead.

LIME-BLOODED MADROSARAI

Madrosarais with lime blood have often produced impressive innovations and enacted great changes throughout the Virtuum and beyond. The blood in these veins is seen as a path into many professions, but especially those where one works with objects. You

become trained in **Crafting**. If you would automatically become trained in Crafting (from your background or class, for example), you instead become trained in another skill of your choice. You gain the **Quick Repair** skill feat.

RED-BLOODED MADROSARAI

Often considered the greatest warriors within madrosarai culture, red-blooded madrosarais have a strong association with unleashing their emotions in acceptably controlled bursts. The crimson-red blood grants you a connection with great madrosarai warriors of the past. You struggle to control your temper but can unleash it in moments of pure aggression at the pitch of battle. You gain the Controlled Rage action.

Controlled Rage

CONTROLLED RAGE ➡

CONCENTRATE EMOTION MENTAL

Source *Galactic Ancestries* pg. 140

Frequency once per day

Requirements You aren't **fatigued** or raging.

You gain a number of temporary Hit Points equal to your level. You also gain a +1 status bonus to damage with melee Strikes. This rage lasts until the end of your next turn, until you fall unconscious, or until the encounter ends, whichever comes first. You can't voluntarily stop raging. When you stop raging, you lose any temporary Hit Points from this rage.

Special If you have the **Rage class feature**, increase the number of temporary Hit Points you gain from raging by 2.

STONE-BLOODED MADROSARAI

One of the muted madrosarai bloodlines, stone-bloods are often employed as medics or philosophers. You always take time to analyze a situation rather than reacting rashly. You can cast the *analyze target* cantrip as an arcane innate spell at will. A cantrip is heightened to a spell rank equal to half your level rounded up. Increase the status bonus granted by *analyze target* by 1.

TEAL-BLOODED MADROSARAI

Of the bloodlines, teal is the most commonly found among madrosarais. This bloodline is known to represent the most dedicated of workers and those seeking to serve their species and the wider needs of the Virtuum. With this blood in your veins, you gain

access to a greater resilience that you can employ while performing your duties. You gain the Madrosarai Tenacity reaction.

Madrosarai Tenacity

MADROSARAI TENACITY

Source *Galactic Ancestries* pg. 140

Frequency once per day

Trigger You would be reduced to 0 Hit Points but not immediately killed

You avoid being knocked out and remain at 1 Hit Point, and your **wounded** condition increases by 1.

UMBER-BLOODED MADROSARAI

A relatively new bloodline that appeared following the Gap, those of the umber bloodline possess powerful psychic abilities that seem linked with events that not even they can remember. You gain one cantrip from the **occult** spell list. You can cast this cantrip as an innate occult spell at will. A cantrip is heightened to a spell rank equal to half your level rounded up. Replace all instances of **arcane** or **Arcana** in all madrosarai ancestry feats you gain with **occult** and **Occultism** respectively, including the tradition of all innate spells you gain, the traits of the feats, and the feat's prerequisites.